

Spoken Tutorial on Understanding API

Module	An Introduction to Building with AI
Episode	1. Understanding API
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is. 2. Explain the role of an API in AI applications. 3. Identify how an API acts as a messenger. 4. Apply the API concept to a food delivery app.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• What is an API? • API as a Messenger • Food Delivery App using API
Meta Tags	API, Application Programming Interface, AI, Artificial Intelligence, Development, Messenger, Prompting, Food Delivery App, Software, Integration, System Integration, Communication
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Module 2: Art of the Prompt

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on Understanding API .
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is. • Explain its role in AI applications. • Identify how an API acts as a messenger. • Apply the API concept to a food delivery app.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should have completed Module 2: Art of the Prompt .

Illustration of a restaurant scene with a customer (application), a waiter (API), and a kitchen (AI model), showing the flow of order and food.	What exactly is an API? An API, or Application Programming Interface, acts as a messenger. It connects your application with an AI model. Think of it like a waiter in a restaurant. You, the customer, give your order, or prompt, to the waiter, the API. The waiter takes your order to the kitchen, which is the AI model. The kitchen prepares your dish, the AI response. The waiter then brings your dish back to you. You don't need to know how the kitchen works.
Illustration showing a food delivery app with multiple, direct, and complex connections to individual restaurant systems, indicating a tangled and inefficient process.	Now, imagine building a food delivery app. What if you built it without an API? You would need to connect directly to each restaurant's system. You would have to understand their unique databases. You would handle every communication detail yourself. This would lead to a very complex and difficult system to manage.
Illustration showing a food delivery app connecting to a single, standardized restaurant API, which then efficiently manages communication with the restaurant's internal system.	But here's where an API makes a difference. With an API, your app sends a simple request to the restaurant's API. This request specifies the order you want to place. The restaurant's API then handles all communication with its internal system. It retrieves menu items, places orders, and confirms delivery status. This makes the entire process efficient and smooth.
Side-by-side comparison: On the left, a tangled network representing the vague approach; on the right, a streamlined connection representing the API improved approach.	Let's compare the two approaches. The vague approach needs direct, complex integration with each restaurant. The API improved approach uses a standardized interface. This simplifies development and ensures scalability. It allows seamless interaction with multiple restaurants. All this happens through a single connection.
Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We defined an API as a messenger between applications and AI models. We used the restaurant analogy to understand this concept. We also saw how APIs simplify complex interactions. We demonstrated this with a food delivery application example.

Assignment Slide	Now as an assignment, Think about a weather app or a travel booking site. Describe how APIs might be used in these applications. Explain how they fetch and display information from various sources. Compare the results.
EduPyramids logo	This Spoken Tutorial is brought to you by EduPyramids Educational Services Private Limited, SINE, IIT Bombay. Thank you for joining.